



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

FEB 2019

In this Issue:

<i>Calendar</i>	<i>2</i>
<i>Worship Schedule</i>	<i>3</i>
<i>Youth & Children</i>	<i>4</i>
<i>Summer Programs</i>	<i>5</i>
<i>4th Quarter Snapshot</i>	<i>6</i>
<i>Peter Pan</i>	<i>7</i>
<i>Things to do</i>	<i>8,9</i>
<i>Worship</i>	<i>10</i>
<i>Pastor's Message</i>	<i>11</i>

SUNDAY WORSHIP

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:15 am Fellowship and Education for All Ages

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

February

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

Minnehaha Calendar

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If your event or meeting is not on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.						1 9a M. Mazvydas Classes/Gathering 10a Music Lesson 11a Lithuanian Dancing 2p Peter Pan 7p Peter Pan
2 Super Bowl / Groundhog Day/ Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10-15a Sunday School & Faith Forum 11a Worship with Band 12p Youth Superbowl Party 7p SAA	3 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1-30p Al-Anon 6-30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6-30p Finance	4 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10-30a Food Shelf 6-30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	5 9-30a Minnehaha Connection Gathering [MCG] (host: Judy Durfey) 10a Staff Meeting 5-30p Methodicals 5-30p Wed Dinner & Programming 6-15p Chancel Choir 6-15p MCG (Kate Stower)	6 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9-30a Minnehaha Playgroup 10a MCG (host: Cec Wilson Holder) 6p Play Rehearsal 6-30p Boy Scout Adult Meeting	7 10a Al-Anon 6-30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6-30p RCA 7p First Friday Films	8 9a M. Mazvydas Classes/Gathering 10a Music Lesson 11a Lithuanian Dancing 2p Peter Pan 7p Peter Pan
9 9a Worship with Organ 10-15a Sunday School & Faith Forum 10-15a Young Family Sunday School 11a Worship with Band 2p Peter Pan 2p Minnehaha Youth Group 6-30p Togo Church 7p SAA	10 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1-30p Al-Anon 6-30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6-30p Den Meeting	11 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10-30a Food Shelf 6-30p Church Council 6-30p Nokomis Neighborhood Group	12 5-30p Methodicals 5-30p Wed Dinner & Programming 6-15p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	13 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9-30a Minnehaha Playgroup 7p MCG (host: Sarah Hicks)	14 Valentine's Day Newsletter items due 10a Al-Anon 10a Music Class 6-30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6-30p RCA 7p Taizé	15 9-15a School Gathering 9-30a Lithuanian Independence Day Celebration 10a Music Lesson 5-30p Potluck and Games at Becketwood
16 9a Worship with Organ 10-15a Sunday School & Faith Forum 11a Worship with Band 7p SAA	17 Presidents' Day 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1-30p Al-Anon 6-30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	18 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10-30a Food Shelf 6-30p Toastmasters (Taleweavers)	19 9-30a MCG (host: Judy Durfey) 5-30p Methodicals 5-30p Newcomer Class 5-30p Wed Dinner & Programming 6-15p Chancel Choir 6-15p MCG (host: Kate Stower)	20 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9-30a Minnehaha Playgroup 10a MCG (host: Cec Wilson Holder) 6-30p Trustees	21 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6-30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6-30p RCA	22 7a MinneHarvest 9a M. Mazvydas Classes/Gathering 10a Music Lesson 11a Lithuanian Dancing
23 9a Worship with Organ 10-15a Mardi Gras Pancake Breakfast 11a Worship with Band 12p Therapy Dog Testing 4p Middle School Youth Group & Confirmation 6-30p Togo Church 7p SAA	24 10a Overeaters Anonymous 1-30p Al-Anon 6-30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6-30p Den Meeting	25 Mardi Gras 9a Fun & Fitness Group 10-30a Food Shelf 6-30p SPR	26 Ash Wednesday 5-30p Methodicals 5-30p Wed Dinner & Programming 6-15p Chancel Choir 6-30p Ash Wednesday Worship	27 9a Fun & Fitness Group 9-30a Minnehaha Playgroup 7p MCG (host: Sarah Hicks)	28 10a Al-Anon 10a Music Class 6-30p Boy Scout Crew 1 6-30p RCA	29 8-30a Nokomis Neighborhood Group (rescheduled) 9a M. Mazvydas Classes/Gathering 10a Music Lesson 11a Lithuanian Dancing

Worship in February

The series on the Beatitudes continues through February, and we end the month with a celebration of our summer camping programs on Feb. 23. Both services on that day will conclude with our pick-up "marching" band playing "When the Saints Come Marching In" and we'll have a pancake mardi gras celebration in the Fellowship Hall instead of any Faith Formation. Lent begins with our Ash Wednesday service on February 26.

2nd	"The Pure in Heart"	Matthew 5:1-2, 8 <i>Communion, Infant Recognition</i>
9th	"Peacemakers"	Matthew 5:1-2, 9
16th	"Poor in Spirit"	Matthew 5:1-3 <i>Minnehaha United Methodist Women Awards</i>
23rd	Camping Sunday	
26th	Ash Wednesday Worship 6:30pm	

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

RE M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

February 14

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

- March 7 – New Auction!
- April 9 – Maundy Thursday Seder
- April 10 – Good Friday Taizé
- April 12 – Easter!
- May 5-15 – General Conference of the UMC held in Minneapolis
- May 17 – One worship service at 10:00 with Children's Musical and Celebration of Gifts & Talents
- May 24 – One worship service at 10:00 with fire drill following
- May 31 – One worship service at 10:00 for Graduation Sunday
- May 31 – 6-8 p.m. Minnesota Methodists Celebrate the Blues at Minnehaha

A New Way to Auction



Share Your Gifts & Talents

Wash windows, donate handyman services, rake leaves, offer a weekend at your cabin, knit homemade mittens or socks, bake a cake or pie every month for a year & more!

SUE CLAUDE: (612) 834-4871 or sue.claude@live.com

Saturday, March 7 • 11AM – 1PM

YOUTH
@ Minnehaha UMC

**SUNDAY, FEB 2ND
GET YOUR**

End-Zone Enchiladas

ENCHILADAS WILL BE SOLD FROM 10-11AM
AT MINNEHAHA UMC

\$12 FOR A PACKAGE OF 4

**PROFITS GO TO SUPPORT
MINNEHAHA YOUTH PROGRAMS**



Minnehaha Children, Youth, and Family Ministries

In the midst of winter cold, we are hard at work planning for Lent (with the promise of spring so closely attached) and for Summer Programming (remember green grass and sunshine?). There are a lot of good things going on right now, too, of course, and we're not trying to wish away the winter even as we make plans for warmer days. We've got entertainment (two weekends of shows offer plenty of opportunities to see Peter Pan), weekly fun on Sundays and Wednesdays, celebrating Leap Day with a family morning, opportunities to serve through MinneHarvest (always on the 4th Saturday of the month), and playgroup each Thursday.

Of course, we are looking ahead to summer, and on Sunday, Feb. 23rd we will launch our summer program registration at Camping Sunday. You can mark your calendars now though for our many great opportunities - dates are enclosed in this newsletter.

What do you enjoy about winter? What do you look forward to in summer?
We're grateful for your presence in this community, in each and every season, and blessed to be in a community that can plan for a meaningful future, together.

Happy February,
Jenia Strom
Director of Children, Youth, and Family Ministries
education@minnehaha.org



Family LEAP MORNING

SATURDAY, FEB. 29TH 2020
9:30-11:30AM AT MINNEHAHA

What are you doing with your extra day?

Join us at Minnehaha for a morning of play, games, conversation, and coffee & donuts, of course!



FEED MY STARVING CHILDREN

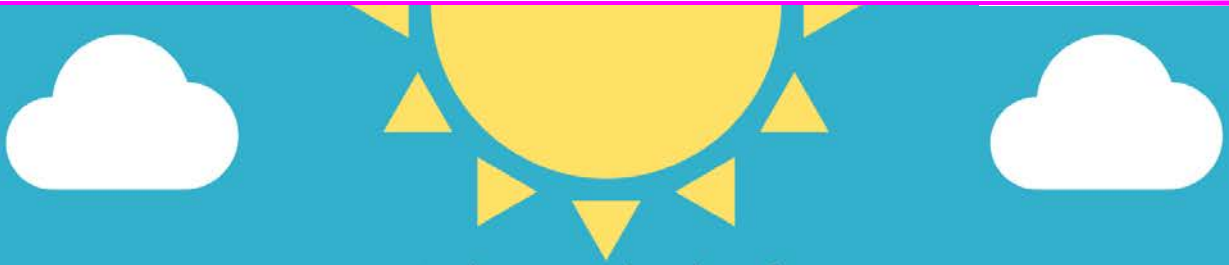


MINNEHAHA YOUTH (6TH-12TH GRADE)
ARE HEADING TO THE EAGAN LOCATION
OF FEED MY STARVING CHILDREN.

Monday, 17th February

11:15am-2:30pm

We'll meet at Minnehaha and carpool.
RSVP required.



Mark your calendars for

2020 SUMMER PROGRAMMING

with Minnehaha United Methodist Church

CAMPS AT MINNEHAHA

REGISTRATION OPENS FEB. 23

Vacation Bible School: Knights of the North Castle

June 17-19th, 9-11:30am

For preschoolers - 5th graders

Music and Drama Camp: *Minnehaha Falls, The Musical*

August 3-7, 9-3pm with performances on Aug 7, 8, & 9th

For 1st - 8th graders

CAMPS THROUGH CAMP MINNESOTA

Teddy Bear Camp

June 28-30 at Camp Koronis

A great first sleep away camp!

REGISTER TODAY!

For 6-9 year olds

Trailblazers Camp

July 5-8 at Camp Koronis

For 8-12 year olds

Pathways Camp

July 12-17 at Camp Koronis

For 9-13 year olds

Teen Speciality Camp

July 19-24 at Camp Koronis

For 13-18 year olds

Grandparent/GrandChild Camp

July 19-21 at Koinonia

FAMILY CAMPING WEEKEND

REGISTRATION OPENS FEB 23

Intergenerational Camping Trip - All ages welcome!

August 21-23 at Baker Park Reserve



WWW.MINNEHAHA.ORG

Minnehaha Snapshot: Fourth Quarter 2019

In the fourth quarter, Minnehaha hosted Halloween and Harvest Dinner & Square Dance events. Our youth raked yards and shopped for toys for Food Shelf clients. Wednesday Night Suppers fed 80 to 90 people at each meal. Volunteers served food at Simpson Shelter. Plus a lot more!

81 KIDS & YOUTH AT XMAS PAGEANT



On December 15, church pews were filled for the Christmas pageant. Eighty-one children and youth (plus Jefferson) performed. Watch it on our YouTube channel.

8 ATTENDED NOV. 13 NEWCOMER CLASS



Eight people attended the Nov. 13 Newcomer Class. If you see somebody new, say "Hi!"

20 PREPARED THE CHURCH FOR ADVENT



On November 30, 20 kids, youth and adults decorated the Narthex, made origami stars, and picked up the Sanctuary Christmas tree to prepare the church for Advent.

100 PERCENT PAID IN FULL



All bills, mortgage and apportionment payments were paid through December 31. The end-of-year appeal raised over \$10,000 to balance the 2019 budget.

77 PERCENT OF BLDG. LOAN PAID OFF



As of the end of 2019, we've paid off 77% of our 2010 building and remodeling project.

12 ADULTS AT POTLUCK & GAME NIGHT



On November 16, twelve adults ate assorted hot dishes and played a 1981 edition of Trivial Pursuit.

88 AT HARVEST DINNER AND SQUARE DANCE



The Harvest Dinner and Square Dance on October 26 brought in 88 people and raised \$2,000 for the church!

35 ATTENDED BLUE TAIZE WORSHIP



On December 13, 35 attended the Blue Christmas Taizé service of meditation, music & prayer. Taizé worship is on the 2nd Friday of the month at 7:00 p.m.

188 FOOD SHELF CLIENTS GOT TOYS



Thanks to your generosity, 188 clients of the Minnehaha Food Shelf received toys, gifts, hats and mittens for Christmas. Thank you for your generous support of this ministry!

Contribution Reports for 2019

Contribution Reports for 2019 have been processed and printed. They will be available at in the Narthex Sundays at the church. The remainder will be mailed by the end of January.

There seems to be a glitch in the system and I'm not sure everyone's report actually printed. If you think you should have a report and you don't receive one, please contact me at shirley@yeoman.com or leave a message at the church office.

Please review your report carefully when you receive it and let me know right away if you think there are errors or if you have questions.

Shirley Yeoman; Financial Secretary

GAME NIGHT POTLUCK

Join us for food, fun and conversation for our 3rd Annual "Top the Tater" Potluck on Saturday, February 15, from 5:30 to 9 pm. Bring your favorite tater topping, an appetizer, side dish, or dessert to share and prepare to design a delectable spud masterpiece. We meet at Becketwood's Windsor Room, located on 4300 W River Pkwy. Hope to see you there!

EMAIL TRACY GULLIVER
AT TRACYGULLIVER@GMAIL.COM,
OR CALL 651-274-1657



THE MINNEHAHA PLAYERS PRESENT:

Peter Pan, Jr.



A musical based on the play by J.M. Barrie.

FRIDAY, JAN. 31 - 7PM

SATURDAY, FEB. 1 - 2PM & 7PM

SATURDAY, FEB. 8 - 2PM & 7PM

SUNDAY, FEB. 9 - 2PM

\$12/adult; \$6/children & seniors

Family Cap of \$30

AT MINNEHAHA UMC

3701 E. 50TH STREET

WWW.MINNEHAHA.ORG

Lyrics by Carolyn Leigh
Music by Morris (Moose) Charlap
Additional Lyrics by Betty Camden & Adolph Green
Additional Music by Jule Styne
Originally Directed, Choreographed, & Adapted by Jerome Robbins.

Peter Pan Jr. is presented through special arrangement with and all authorized materials are supplied by Music Theatre International, New York, NY 212-541-4684 mtishows.com.



CALLING MINNEHAHA MUSICIANS - ALL AGES & ABIILITIES

Join our Minnehaha Marching Band on Sunday,
Feb. 23rd for When the Saints Go Marching In.
Interested? Talk to Eric Strom or email
childrens.choir@minnehaha.org

For Mahle Updates: facebook.com/HamlineWesleyCenter

SAVE THE DATE: together at the table



Mahle Lecture
In Progressive Christian Thought

Tentative Schedule:

FEBRUARY 23

10AM Sermon at Hamline Church
3–5PM with Minnesota Methodists, United Methodist
Church of Anoka

FEBRUARY 25

4PM Conversation with Two Bishops, Kay Fredericks Ballroom
5:30–6:45PM Reception, Kay Fredericks Ballroom
7PM Keynote Lecture, Sundin Hall

FEBRUARY 26

10:30AM District Ash Wednesday Service, Hamline Church
7PM Ash Wednesday, Hamline Church



karen p. oliveto

**United Methodist Church Bishop
Mountain Sky Area**

The 2020 Mahle Lecture in Progressive Christian Thought...

...explores and articulates contemporary forms of Christian theology and provides students opportunities to learn its relevance to personal, social, economic and political life. This year's guest, Bishop Karen P. Oliveto, will engage with campus community and congregations about the challenges and opportunities of the United Methodist Church's current struggle to be "together at the table" and yet open to new paths.



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9:30-11:30am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

education@minnehaha.org

612.721.6231

Sunday Morning Faith Forums

Adult Faith Forums (Sunday mornings, 10:15-11:00) will follow our theme of Love for the month of February as we remind ourselves why we are a Reconciling Congregation. Utilizing Steve Harper's book, *Holy Love*, Matthew Palombo will lead us in a conversation about how LGBTQ issues are treated in the Bible, in the history of the church, and in our current theology.



Celebration on February 15 @ 11AM

Join us on Saturday, February 15 at 11:00 a.m. for a Lithuania Independence Day celebration in the Fellowship Hall and Gym.

The Martynas Mazvydas Lithuanian Heritage School (our newest renters) will present a program of dance, music and remembrance, followed by a get-together with coffee and snacks at noon. All are invited!



Is whistleblower Katharine Gun, a British intelligence specialist, a traitor or a hero? When is it right to "betray" your country? Have we a higher loyalty?

Join us at Minnehaha UMC on Friday, February 7 at 7:00 p.m. in Room #210 as we watch and discuss this timely film about the U.S. trying to engage the U.K. in the war against Iraq.

Keira Knightly, Matt Smith and Ralph Fiennes star.

Volunteers Needed for Food for Elderly

Riverview Senior Housing (5360 Riverview Rd.) is in need of a couple more volunteer to continue providing affordable food onsite. Second Harvest Heartland brings food over in a truck on the 1st and 3rd Wednesdays of the month. Residents help carry in the food, set up tables, and then clean up after the distribution, but a few extra hands are needed in addition to theirs from 9:15-11:15 a.m. We have a person from Minnehaha helping but need another 1-3 people to join the ranks. That way, not every person needs to come every time. If you can help, please let Becky know and she'll get you in touch with the appropriate people. Thank you!

MinneHarvest

Our free food give-away once a month (on the fourth Saturday of the month) is a source of food relied upon by many, and it happens through volunteers who come each month. Please join us on Feb. 22. You can volunteer anytime between 6:30 and 10:30 a.m. We start setting up at 6:30, unload the trucks starting at 7, serve the food at 9:00, and are usually done cleaning up by 10:30. Join us for all or any portion of that time, and bring a friend!

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on February 14 for a time of renewal. And, because we know that a service with lots of silence is not always child-friendly, we have child care available during the service.



Ash Wednesday

Lent begins on Wednesday, February 26 this year, and we will be starting our Lenten observance with an Ash Wednesday service at 6:30 p.m. If you've never been to an Ash Wednesday service before, this is a more solemn service that includes ashes made from the burning of palms from last year's Palm Sunday. We "impose" the ashes as a reminder of how sometimes even our best intentions can go awry, and as a reminder of our own mortality. All ages are invited to participate in the service.



Newcomer Class

We'll be holding an introduction and orientation class for anyone new to Minnehaha or interested in joining on February 19. Please join us during the Wednesday night dinner at 5:30 p.m. in the Fellowship Hall. Your meal is on us, and we'll have a table set aside for the class. If you want to stay for children & youth programming or choir rehearsal at 6:15, we would be delighted! Just to give us an idea of numbers, please RSVP to becky@minnehaha.org. If you are interested, but cannot make the class, our next class will be Saturday morning, March 21.

Flags for Lament

Following the Ash Wednesday service on February 26, we will also be engaging in an activing for our month of "Lament" in March by placing 48 rainbow flags around the church property. Each flag symbolizes one year of anti-LGBTQ policies in our denomination. We will have them up for the month of March as we lament the discriminatory policies of the United Methodist Church, and in hopes that those policies will soon come to an end.



Looking for Love in All the Wrong Places

“Though we cannot think alike, may we not love alike?” wrote John Wesley, one of the founder of United Methodism. And, indeed, this has been one of the foundations of our denomination. While we have rules about all sorts of things that order us, we have very few rules about our theology. As a result, we have become a broad tent denomination, held together by some basic theological principles, dedicated to both social holiness (inward transformation) and social justice. Wesley continued, “May we not be of one heart, though we are not of one opinion? Without all doubt, we may. Herein all the children of God may unite, notwithstanding these smaller differences.” Even with Wesley’s optimism, the denomination has come apart and merged in a variety of ways over the last 200 years. And, we are at an impasse now. It seems that not thinking alike on some issues is, indeed, going to prevent us from loving alike. Some would say that who and how we love is at the heart of this impasse, but I think the issue is really a deeper one of theology and structure. Some parts of our denomination chafe at the concept of too much grace, wanting a person’s belief in God to be the thing that gets us into God’s grace. Others hold to the idea of that God’s grace is available to everyone, even those who think God does not exist. What that grace means is also part of the debate. Does grace mean entrance into heaven? Would God accept, eternally, someone who doesn’t believe? Or, someone who has acted in ways that are considered outside God’s code of conduct? The issue has been neatly narrowed down into LGBTQ, but the theological differences underneath this disagreement show that we are thinking very far apart from each other.

The United Methodist Church was created as a connected denomination. Our structure, our theology, our rules are intended to hold us together. While groups do break away, it is hard to do. And, the few times that our denomination has split, it has been complicated and hard work. As we sit poised on the verge of one of those times, I am hearing from all corners of the denomination a reminder to love one another. As we realize that we who have come together in this denomination are not really able to continue to live together, and that the differences in our theology and the ways in which we want to organize ourselves have created irreconcilable differences, it turns out that we do, still, want to hold to some of John Wesley’s teachings. While we are definitely not of one opinion on sexuality, or on grace, we are reminded that we can still hold one another in love, even as we go down different paths.

In Joy,
Becky



3701 East 50th Street
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office@minnehaha.org

2/20



ASH WEDNESDAY

FEBRUARY 26

Dinner at 5:30pm
Service at 6:30pm



EXPLORING SPIRITUAL PRACTICES

LENT AT MINNEHAHA 2020